

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 1/12: Cold War security dilemma

USSR -> security belt in eastern Europe

WEST -> reads belt as expansion

CONTAINMENT -> USSR reads encirclement

RESULT -> defensive acts reproduce hostility

MUST REMEMBER: Truman containment, Marshall aid, NATO, Soviet consolidation and the Warsaw Pact frame one sequence, while Korea, Cuba, Vietnam, détente, renewed tension and the 1989-91 end phase changed its form.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 2/12: Origins weighting

IDEOLOGY -> defines friend and threat
POWER VACUUM -> creates strategic stakes
ATOMIC ASYMMETRY -> raises mistrust
WARTIME LEGACY -> begins rivalry with low trust

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 3/12: Containment sequence

1947 -> Truman Doctrine and Marshall Plan
1948 -> Czechoslovakia hardens division
1948-49 -> Berlin blockade and airlift
1949 -> NATO, Soviet bomb and communist China

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 4/12: Korean escalation

NORTH INVADES -> June 1950

UN/US FORCE -> advances north

CHINA -> enters the war

1953 -> frontier remains near 38th parallel

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 5/12: Thaw versus control

THAW -> Korean armistice and Austrian treaty

COEXISTENCE -> rhetoric of reduced tension

WARSAW PACT -> bloc institutionalised in 1955

HUNGARY 1956 -> Soviet sphere enforced by force

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 6/12: Berlin and Cuba

BERLIN WALL 1961 -> division made physical

CUBA 1962 -> nuclear confrontation peaks

COMMON RULE -> avoid direct general war

RESULT -> stability through restraint, not settlement

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 7/12: Global Cold War map

ASIA -> Korea, Vietnam and China

LATIN AMERICA -> Cuba and Chile

MIDDLE EAST -> Suez and Arab-Israeli wars

AFGHANISTAN -> renewed confrontation after 1979

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 8/12: Middle East causal layers

LOCAL -> nationalism, territory and refugees

POST-IMPERIAL -> decolonisation and borders

STRATEGIC -> oil and state security

SUPERPOWERS -> internationalise rather than create all causes

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 9/12: Detente mechanism

CUBA -> nuclear risk becomes undeniable

SALT I 1972 -> arms competition regulated

US-CHINA OPENING -> triangular diplomacy

HELSINKI 1975 -> norms without ending rivalry

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 10/12: Non-alignment as agency

REFUSAL -> no automatic bloc membership

SOVEREIGNTY -> room for independent policy

LEVERAGE -> aid and support sought from both sides

CAUTION -> pressure persists despite autonomy

CLOSE DISTINCTION: Bipolar structure did not erase non-alignment, decolonised-state agency,
intra-bloc disputes or the Sino-Soviet split; proxy arenas had local causes and actors.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 11/12: Communist bloc fracture

AFTER 1956 -> Sino-Soviet relations deteriorate

DOCTRINE/TERRITORY -> dispute widens

1972 -> US-China opening exploits the rift

1979 -> communist China attacks communist Vietnam

EVIDENCE LIMIT: Nuclear deterrence constrained direct superpower war but enabled arms racing and risk; détente was managed competition, not the end of ideology or conflict.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 12/12: Cold War answer spine

ORIGINS -> security dilemma read through ideology

CRISES -> Berlin, Korea and Cuba define limits

GLOBAL -> local causes, agency and fractured blocs

END -> structural weakness plus reform and non-use of force